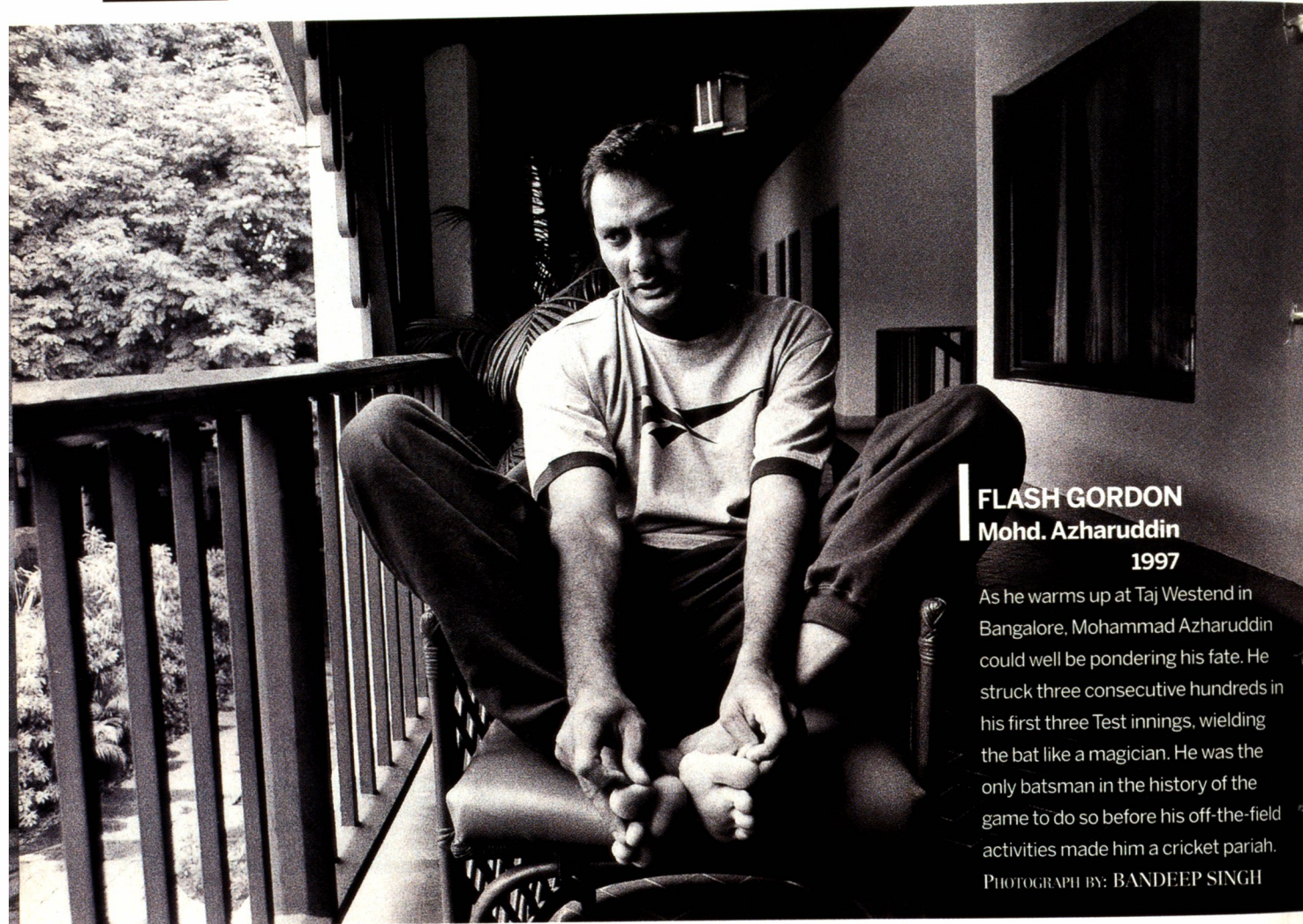
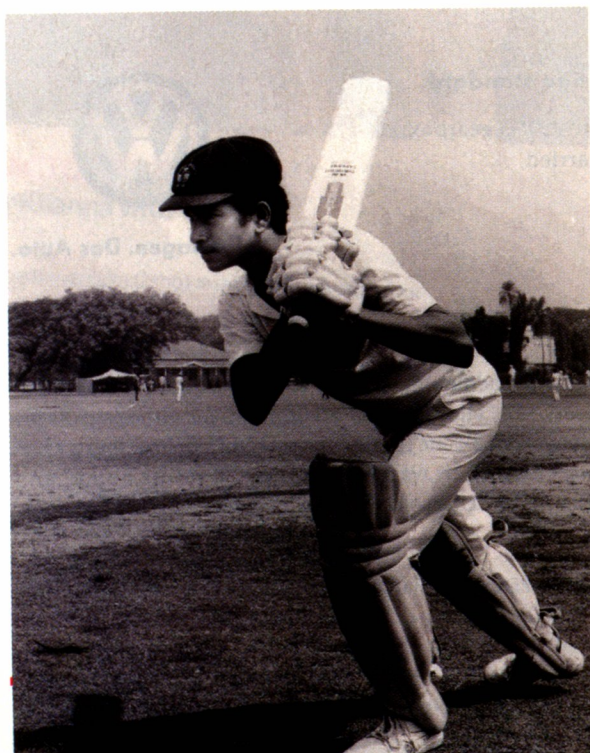




FLASH GORDON
Mohd. Azharuddin
1997

As he warms up at Taj Westend in Bangalore, Mohammad Azharuddin could well be pondering his fate. He struck three consecutive hundreds in his first three Test innings, wielding the bat like a magician. He was the only batsman in the history of the game to do so before his off-the-field activities made him a cricket pariah.

PHOTOGRAPH BY: BANDEEP SINGH



RUNS AND ROSES

Sachin Tendulkar

1989

Sachin has truly lived up to the adage "Morning shows the day". Even in his first season in first class cricket, the 15-year-old school boy made a record many seasoned in the business would fall for—a total of 423 runs scored in five Ranji Trophy matches at an average of 70.5. As INDIA TODAY reported in 1989, "Veterans are nearly unanimous that Sachin will soon be sporting the India blazer."

PHOTOGRAPH BY: MOHAN PARIKH

Compiled by Anamika Chatterjee and Purvi Malhotra